A group pastes the continents and comes first with the chart without any gaps in between the continents. The teacher then puts the chart on the board and the children applaud.

"What kind of picture is this? Once I have seen one like this in the atlas, " says Yazhini.

"You are right. This is **Pangea**, the Super Continent, and the Sea around is **Panthalasa**. It was 200 million years ago, when these landmasses moved away from each other to gain the present position as continents and oceans." says the teacher.

"What makes it to move madam?" asks Nila.

"Nothing other than the internal heat of the Earth," says the teacher and continues, "this lesson deals about the continents and oceans in detail".

The Earth is covered by **water** which occupies **71** percent and **land** that occupies **29** percent of the Earth's surface. The surface of the Earth is not even, because it has lofty mountains, deep oceans and other landforms. These landforms can be classified as:

1. First order landforms

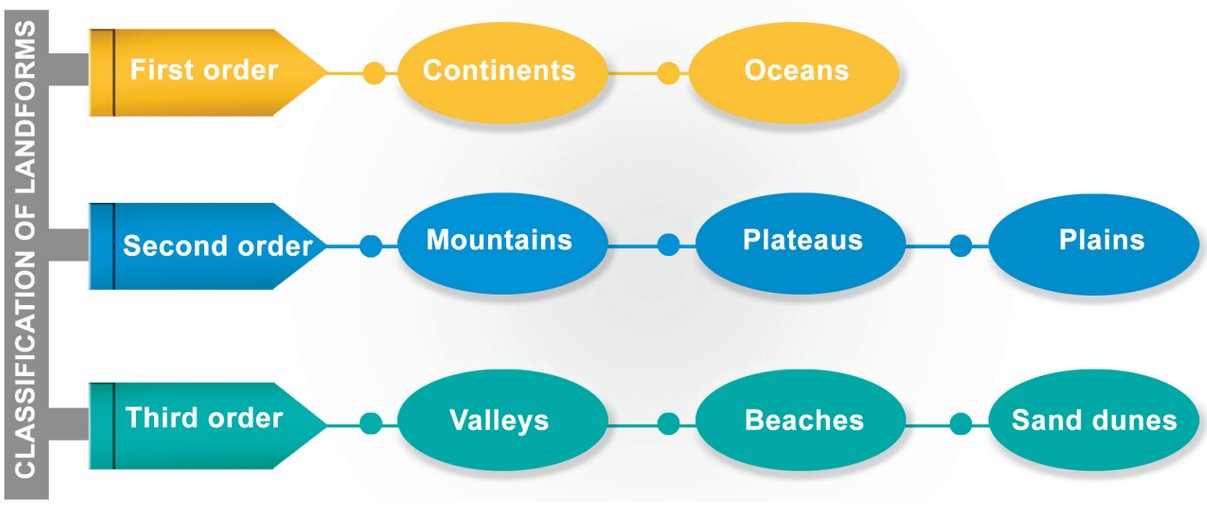
Continents and oceans are grouped as first order landforms. The vast land masses on Earth are called **Continents** and huge water bodies are called **Oceans.** There are seven continents. They are **Asia, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Europe and Australia**. Asia is the largest continent, whereas Australia is the smallest one.

GEO CONNECT:

Land classification - Sangam period

1. **Kurinji** - Mountain and its environs
2. **Mullai** - Forest and its surroundings
3. **Marutham** - Agricultural land and its adjoining areas.
4. **Neithal** - Sea and its environs
5. **Palai** - Desert region

Which of the above landform category do you belong to?



Classification of landforms

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